University Report — Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Prepared on 2 November 2026.

Sample — anonymized demo. This is a real end-to-end search with the student's identity removed (name changed, school and personal finances generalized). It shows the format and depth you get, not a real person's private file.

Your profile

Field	Value
Qualification	A-Level
Subjects	Mathematics A* (predicted), Further Mathematics A* (predicted), Physics A* (predicted), Chemistry A* (predicted)
Grades are	Predicted by your school
Course	BEng/MEng Mechatronics Engineering, BEng/MEng Robotics Engineering
Countries	USA, UK, Australia, Singapore/Malaysia, China
Scholarship needed	Yes
Location	Access to nature / outdoors and new things to explore, Safe area with good local culture, Open to relocating far from family

1. Snapshot

Field	Value
University	Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Location	USA / Cambridge, Massachusetts
Setting	urban university city, across the Charles River from Boston
Type & size	private research university · 4,561 undergraduates (11,816 students in total)
Overall rank	QS #1 in the world, 2026-27 edition (15th consecutive year); QS #1 for Engineering & Technology and for Mechanical, Aeronautical & Manufacturing Engineering
How to apply	MIT's own application portal, not the Common App. Regular Action closes 4 January 2027; Early Action closed 1 November 2026
Admit rate	4.6% overall, 2.0% international (MIT, Class of 2029)

Field	Value
Est. net cost after aid (MYR)	By family income: RM 0 to ~RM 198,300/yr (MIT's own median net prices, 2025-26; approx). See Costs
Your priorities	1. Scholarship · 2. Hands-on experience · 3. Ranking · 4. Location · 5. Employability · 6. Recognition (hard gate)

Key terms

New to these? Here's what the shorthand in this guide means — tap a linked term anywhere below to jump back here.

- **EA** — **Early Action** — apply early for an earlier decision; *non-binding*, so you stay free to compare offers and decline.
- **cost of attendance** — The university's official all-in yearly price — tuition **plus** housing, food, fees, books and personal expenses. This is the number financial aid is measured against, not the tuition figure alone.
- **demonstrated need** — Your cost of attendance minus what the university calculates your family can pay. "Meets 100% of need" means it covers that gap — it does not automatically mean you pay nothing.
- **student contribution** — The amount a US aid package expects *you* (not your parents) to contribute each year, usually from summer or term-time campus work. It is part of the package, so it is not covered by the grant.
- **need-blind** — The university decides admission *without* looking at whether you asked for financial aid — requesting aid can't hurt your chances.
- **CSS Profile** — The College Board's detailed financial-aid application most US universities use to assess your need (separate from the FAFSA).
- **IDOC** — College Board's Institutional Documentation Service — where you upload your parents' tax/income documents for financial aid.
- **fee waiver** — A request to cancel the application fee on the grounds of financial need — so you pay nothing to apply.
- **Common App** — The Common Application — one online form plus one main essay you reuse across many US universities.
- **self-report** — You type your own test scores into the application; you only pay to send official scores once you enrol.
- **School Report** — A form (plus a letter) your school counsellor submits about you and your school.
- **SAT** — A standardised US university-entrance exam; many US universities require the SAT or the ACT.
- **ACT** — A standardised US university-entrance exam; an accepted alternative to the SAT.
- **IELTS** — International English Language Testing System — an English-proficiency test. Some universities waive it if enough of your schooling was taught in English, or accept an English grade (such as SPM 1119 or IGCSE English) instead. Each sets its own rule.

- **JPA** — Malaysian government overseas-study sponsorship (JPA / MARA, via the PKJM programme) — a route to full funding for eligible students.
- **Yayasan Khazanah** — A Malaysian foundation offering competitive scholarships to study at top global universities.
- **OPT** — **Optional Practical Training** — US work permission that lets you work in your field for a limited period after graduating on a student visa.
- **STEM OPT** — **STEM OPT extension** — an extension of OPT for science/engineering degrees, adding more US work authorisation after you graduate.
- **ABET** — The US accreditation board for engineering and technology degrees. An ABET-accredited degree is recognised internationally and eases professional registration back home.
- **Washington Accord** — An international agreement that mutually recognises engineering degrees between member countries (the US, UK, Australia and Malaysia all belong), so an accredited degree carries over.
- **BEM** — **Board of Engineers Malaysia** — the body you register with to practise as an engineer in Malaysia; it recognises accredited degrees via the Washington Accord.
- **MQA** — **Malaysian Qualifications Agency** — the Malaysian body that recognises foreign qualifications; its register lists which foreign degrees it recognises.
- **Common Data Set** — A standardised set of admissions and enrolment statistics each US university publishes, including its admit rate and the profile of the students it admitted.
- **MARA** — **Majlis Amanah Rakyat** — a Malaysian government agency that sponsors and lends to Bumiputera students for pre-university and degree study, locally and abroad.
- **SHIP** — **Student Health Insurance Plan** — the university's own health cover, billed automatically each year unless you prove you have comparable insurance and get a waiver approved.
- **PTPTN** — **Perbadanan Tabung Pendidikan Tinggi Nasional** — Malaysia's national education *loan* fund, not a scholarship. It is aimed at study at approved institutions and is repayable.
- **Kijang Scholarship** — Bank Negara Malaysia's scholarship for high-scoring Malaysians to study abroad in finance-adjacent fields, including data science; it carries a service bond.
- **UROP** — **Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program** — MIT's system for pairing undergraduates with faculty research projects, for pay, for credit or as a volunteer, from first year onwards.
- **GIRs** — **General Institute Requirements** — the core every MIT undergraduate takes whatever the major: maths, physics, chemistry, biology, a lab, plus eight humanities, arts and social science subjects.
- **HASS** — **Humanities, Arts and Social Sciences** — MIT's breadth requirement, eight subjects outside science and engineering, two of them writing-intensive.
- **IAP** — **Independent Activities Period** — the four weeks each January when MIT suspends normal classes for projects, short courses, competitions, internships and travel. No extra tuition for students enrolled in the surrounding terms.
- **MBTA** — **Massachusetts Bay Transportation Authority** — greater Boston's public transport network, known locally as 'the T'; its Red Line subway stops on MIT's campus at Kendall/MIT.

- **E-Verify** — The US government system employers use to confirm a hire may legally work. Only an E-Verify employer can sponsor the STEM OPT extension.
- **USCIS** — **United States Citizenship and Immigration Services** — the US agency that decides immigration applications. You file OPT, STEM OPT and any extension of stay with USCIS, with a fee and a processing wait.
- **QS** — **QS World University Rankings** — one of the three global university league tables, published annually by Quacquarelli Symonds. Weighted heavily toward academic and employer reputation surveys.
- **SPM** — **Sijil Pelajaran Malaysia** — the Malaysian national exam taken at the end of Form 5, before A-Levels or a foundation year.
- **H-1B** — The US employer-sponsored work visa most graduates need after their post-study work permit runs out. It is allocated by lottery, so it is not guaranteed.
- **F-1** — The standard US student visa.

2. Identity & what it's known for

MIT's motto is *Mens et Manus*, "mind and hand". Admissions puts the mission in one line: "MIT's mission is to use science, technology, and other areas of scholarship to make the world better." Paid lab research, machine shops and competition-based classes are part of how the degree is taught.

What it is known for	The evidence
Rank	QS world number one in the 2026-27 edition, for the 15th year running. First in 12 subjects, including Engineering & Technology; Mechanical, Aeronautical & Manufacturing Engineering; Electrical & Electronic Engineering; Computer Science & Information Systems; and Data Science & Artificial Intelligence
A small undergraduate body inside a large research institute	11,816 students: 4,561 undergraduates and 7,255 graduate students
Teaching scale	8 students per faculty member; 796 of 1,162 class sections had fewer than 20 students in fall 2025
Research as the default	MIT says over 90% of undergraduates work on a paid research project through UROP before graduating
Breadth	56 undergraduate majors and 62 minors
People stay and finish	99% of first-years return for a second year; 96% graduate within six years

MIT also publishes its teaching openly. OpenCourseWare has released material from more than 2,500 MIT courses since 2001, free and with no account needed.

3. Who it's for

MIT lists the qualities it looks for and states that "it's really the match between the applicant and the Institute that drives our selection process." In its own words:

Quality	What MIT says
Alignment with the mission	"tutoring a single kid in math changes the world", so scale is not the test
Collaborative and cooperative spirit	"The core of the MIT community is collaboration and cooperation"
Initiative	One of the qualities MIT lists by name
Risk-taking	Applicants who are "not afraid to fail"
Hands-on creativity	"Innovation is risky and messy!"
Intensity, curiosity and excitement	"Choose quality over quantity."
The ability to prioritise balance	"Finding a balance between work and play is incredibly important at MIT and in life"
The character of the MIT community	"Applicants who are a good fit for MIT are trailblazers"

How MIT differs as an institution

Lens	MIT
Curriculum shape	A fixed science core for everyone, then your major. Less free choice in year one than an open-curriculum university such as Brown
Size and setting	4,561 undergraduates on an urban campus
Aid model	Need-blind and full-need for international students, no merit awards. Details in Costs and Scholarships
Culture	Collaboration is an admissions criterion; workload figures are in Campus culture

4. Getting in — requirements and who gets in

MIT publishes its own numbers. The most recent class on its statistics page is the Class of 2029, admitted in 2025.

Measure	Class of 2029
Applications	29,281
Admitted	1,334, which is **4.6%**
Early Action	12,052 applied; 721 admitted (6.0%); 7,486 deferred to Regular Action, of whom 175 were later admitted
Regular Action	17,229 new applicants; 24,715 considered once deferred applicants are added; 603 admitted (2.4% of those considered)
US citizens and permanent residents	22,355 applied; 1,198 admitted (5.4%)
International applicants	**6,926 applied; 136 admitted (2.0%)**
Wait list	561 offered a place; 10 admitted
SAT Maths, middle 50% of admitted students	780–800
SAT Reading and Writing, middle 50%	740–780
ACT composite, middle 50%	34–36
Enrolled class	1,155 students; 11% international, from 56 countries

MIT sets no grade cutoff, and it says "we do not have caps or quotas for countries".

> ⚠️ **MIT requires the SAT or the ACT, and no score is on your file.** MIT's wording is "We require the SAT or ACT." There is no test-optional route. For Regular Action the test must be taken before 31 December 2026. The last SAT sitting before that is **5 December 2026**: registration closes 20 November, late registration 24 November. Registration for the 7 November sitting closed on 27 October, and the next sitting after December is 6 March 2027. With no SAT or ACT taken by 31 December, you cannot apply to MIT this cycle.

What applying here demands, beside your file

Component	What MIT asks	On your file
School record	No cutoff and no required school subjects. Predicted grades are welcome; final grades are only checked if you are admitted	Predicted A*A*A*A*

Component	What MIT asks	On your file
SAT or ACT	Required. No cutoff or recommended score; MIT looks mainly at your highest score in each section across sittings, and you self-report	No score yet
English test	Not required. "Strongly recommended" only if you have used English for fewer than five years or do not speak it at home or in school. If you send one, IELTS minimum is 7 and the recommended score is 7.5. Regular Action applicants must take it before 31 January	No English test yet; A-Levels taught in English
Essays	Four short essays of 100–200 words each, four more responses of 40–50 words, and an optional additional-information box. No long personal statement	Separate from the Common App
Activities	A form with room for four entries, used instead of a CV	No competitions, research or team projects listed yet
Teacher letters	Two. MIT recommends one from a maths or science teacher and one from a humanities, social science or language teacher, and says the split "is not a hard requirement"	All four of your subjects are maths or science
School report	A Secondary School Report with transcript from a counsellor-type recommender	Not yet sent
Interview	With an MIT graduate volunteer, in person where possible, if one is available. If none is, it is waived and "your application will not be adversely affected"	Offered after you apply
Maker Portfolio	Optional, USD 10, reviewed by "MIT faculty and alumni with prolific maker experience"	No finished build listed yet
Application fee	USD 75, or a fee waiver requested inside the application, open to international applicants	Not relevant to the decision

Rounds. Early Action closed on 1 November 2026. Regular Action is due 4 January 2027, with an answer in mid-March. MIT says it has no preference between the two rounds and that there is no strategic benefit to either.

Who actually gets in

- MIT's 2025-26 Common Data Set rates one factor "very important" in admission: character and personal qualities. Class rank is only "considered", and showing interest in MIT is not considered at all.
- The Malaysian admits who reach the news are international-olympiad level. The student admitted for 2025 from Kolej MARA Banting represented Malaysia at the International Mathematical Olympiad three years running and won a bronze medal. The two admitted in 2024 from INTI Penang's A-Level programme both belong to the Malaysian science-olympiad alumni association.

- One of those 2024 admits told the college that "MIT has only accepted one Malaysian undergraduate in the past four years". That is a student's claim, not MIT's. MIT's own international office counted five Malaysian undergraduates enrolled in 2025-26.
- Current students write about applying on the MIT Admissions blogs at mitadmissions.org/blogs. Decision threads appear on r/mitadmissions (reddit.com/r/mitadmissions) each December and March. No thread from it is quoted in this report.

The Maker Portfolio asks "what you make, how you make it, and why you make it", takes up to 25 media attachments and two minutes of video, and MIT says "We are more interested in your build process than your end results." It accepts software: "All code projects must include your codebase (ideally version-controlled) AND a working demonstration of your project."

If you are not admitted. MIT has no foundation or pathway year. The only other undergraduate door is transfer: you need at least two completed terms at another university, you can apply from your second term there, international students can only apply for September entry, and that deadline is 1 March. Not found — MIT's transfer eligibility page gives no admit numbers.

Not yet confirmed

- MIT's deadlines page prints no year. The dates here assume it means this cycle.
- Whether a counsellor can stand in for a humanities teacher: MIT's letters page does not cover a student with no humanities or language teacher.

5. What you'll actually study

You are admitted to MIT, not to a degree. In MIT's words you "apply to the entire university, not to a specific major or school", every first-year starts undeclared, and after year one you may "choose from among any of MIT's courses of study" with "no additional requirements or admission procedures". In the UK model, by contrast, the subject is chosen on the application form.

Stage	What happens
Year one, autumn term and January	Everything is graded Pass or No Record. A pass needs C-minus work or better; a fail leaves no trace on your transcript
Year one, spring term	Graded A, B, C or No Record
Spring of year one	Most students declare a major by the spring Drop Date; it takes effect at the start of summer, with a new adviser in that department
If you want longer	You can stay undeclared into year two, but must choose by the end of it
Years two to four	Your major and the remaining core

The core everyone takes. MIT calls these the GIRs, and they apply whatever you major in:

Requirement	Size
Science	Six subjects: one chemistry, two physics, two mathematics, one biology

Requirement	Size
HASS	Eight subjects, at least two of them communication-intensive
Restricted science and technology electives	Two subjects
Laboratory	12 units
Physical education and wellness	Four courses plus a swimming requirement
Communication within your major	Two communication-intensive subjects

The calendar is two terms with a four-week January period, IAP, between them. The next one runs 4 to 29 January 2027. Regular classes stop and the month fills with short courses, competitions, research and projects.

Routes for robotics and computing. MIT names its majors by number, and calls them Courses.

Route	What it is	Robotics or computing content
Course 2 — Mechanical Engineering	Core subjects in mechanics and materials, dynamics and control, thermal-fluids, design and manufacturing, numerical computation, measurement, plus a thesis and a capstone design subject. 48 units of free electives	Two restricted electives from a list that includes Introduction to Robotics, feedback control and electromechanical robotic systems. There is no separate "robotics track"
Course 2-A — Mechanical Engineering, flexible	The mechanical core plus a concentration of 72 units or more in one focus area	MIT's own example concentrations include "Control, Instrumentation and Robotics" and Entrepreneurship
Course 6 — Electrical Engineering and Computer Science	Several degrees, including 6-2 Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, 6-3 Computer Science and Engineering, 6-4 Artificial Intelligence and Decision Making and 6-5 Electrical Engineering with Computing	The computing route

The mechanical engineering department suggests taking a basic electronics subject early.

Switching and combining. Before you declare, switching costs nothing. A double major is possible but has rules: at least three terms completed, a cumulative average of 4.0 or better on MIT's 5.0 scale, all the requirements of both majors, and sign-off from both departments. Minors are the lighter option, with 62 on offer.

Strength in your field. QS ranks MIT first in the world for both its mechanical and its electrical engineering subject groups. No MIT degree is titled "Robotics".

6. Signature academic experiences

Experience	What it is	When you can start
UROP	MIT's undergraduate research programme. It "cultivates and supports research partnerships between MIT undergraduates and faculty". You can be paid, earn credit or volunteer, in autumn, January, spring or summer	Year one. There is a dedicated January funding deadline for first-time first-years
2.007 Design and Manufacturing I	A required Course 2 subject. Each student gets "an identical kit of parts" and designs, machines and programs a robot for a head-to-head competition whose theme changes every year. MIT's own account says winning does not affect your grade	After declaring Course 2
Capstone design, such as 2.009 The Product Engineering Process	The capstone design subject every Course 2 student takes in some form	Final year
MakerLodge	A student-run programme that trains first-years on shop tools; you make a couple of small objects and can then return in open hours for personal, class or research projects	Year one
Edgerton Center teams	Student-run engineering teams, including RoboTeam, Combat Robotics Club, Driverless (full-scale autonomous race cars), Arcturus (autonomous boats and a submarine), Motorsports, the Solar Electric Vehicle Team, the Rocket Team and MITERS, a student-run project space and machine shop	Year one. The Edgerton page does not say whether teams expect prior experience
Sandbox Innovation Fund	Seed funding of up to USD 25,000 (~RM 101,000) with mentoring, taking no ownership stake, open to "all MIT undergraduate and graduate students". MIT stresses "Our program is not a competition."	Any year
Martin Trust Center for MIT Entrepreneurship	The entrepreneurship hub. It runs delta v, a summer accelerator for student founders, and Orbit, an online hub with more than 8,000 members for finding co-founders and advice	Any year

Experience	What it is	When you can start
MISTI	MIT's international internship, teaching and study-abroad programme. Singapore is one of its locations; Malaysia is not	Set by each programme

7. Campus culture

Collaborative by design. Collaboration is an admissions criterion here, and MIT backs it with infrastructure: psetpartners.mit.edu exists to "make it easier for MIT students to find classmates to work with on problem sets", matching people each week by timetable and preference.

Intense, and MIT measures it. In MIT's 2020 Quality of Life survey, 46% of undergraduates called their academic workload "too heavy" and 65% said they felt overwhelmed frequently. Those figures are from 2020, and they are the newest undergraduate breakdown this report found. Your first term is graded Pass or No Record.

Aspect	What it looks like
Teaching style	Lectures, weekly problem sets and lab or project subjects
Startups	19% of bachelor's graduates going into work in 2025 expected to join a startup, on MIT's rounded figure
Humour	Playful and technical; see "hacks" under Notable facts
Sport	33 varsity teams, the largest Division III programme in the United States. MIT says "about a quarter of our students are varsity athletes". Division III gives no athletic scholarships. MIT adds 30-plus club sports and 20 intramural sports
Fraternities and sororities	42% of undergraduate men and 26% of undergraduate women belong to one, on the 2025-26 Common Data Set

8. Student life, housing & food

Housing. "MIT requires all first year students to live on campus for the duration of their first year at MIT." There are 20 residence halls, and "each residence has its own culture and customs, created by students". First-years tour the halls during Residence Exploration, a multi-day event, and can then ask to swap out of their temporary hall into one they prefer. The swap never moves you without your consent.

Meal plans. A meal plan is compulsory if you live in a hall with its own dining room: Baker House, Maseeh Hall, New Vassar, Next House or Simmons Hall. First-years in those halls must take one of the two largest plans, each USD 4,051.50 a semester (~RM 16,400), which is the figure MIT's cost of attendance already assumes for food. McCormick Hall's dining room is listed as closed for renovation. Every dining hall serves vegetarian and vegan dishes.

Life outside class. Beyond the engineering teams in Signature academic experiences, the January period has no regular classes, and the Kendall/MIT subway stop connects to central Boston. For the

outdoors, the MIT Outing Club runs hiking, climbing, skiing, cycling and canoeing trips across New England, rents gear to members and keeps a cabin in central New Hampshire.

Your first weeks. MIT runs more than 20 optional pre-orientation programmes before the main orientation, then orientation itself with an academic fair and residence tours. People refer to majors and buildings by number from the start (see Notable facts).

Student voices. The MIT Admissions blogs carry current students writing about housing choices, failing a first exam and what a week looks like. The student newspaper, The Tech, covers dining and housing changes. Enrolled students answer questions on r/mit (reddit.com/r/mit). No thread from it is quoted in this report.

9. The city, the area & belonging

Cambridge, Massachusetts. A dense, walkable university city on the north bank of the Charles River, facing Boston. MIT sits at the river's edge with the Kendall Square technology district on its eastern side.

Topic	The picture
Transport	Kendall/MIT subway station is on campus, on the MBTA line that runs into central Boston one way and to Harvard the other
Safety	Cambridge police recorded 3,611 serious crimes in 2025 on preliminary figures, 474 of them violent, with one homicide in the city all year. MIT has its own police department with a 24-hour emergency line and a SafeRide shuttle
Central Square	The next subway stop from MIT. It accounted for 38% of the city's aggravated assaults and 62% of its street robberies in the 2025 report
Weather	Cold, snowy winters. The average January night in Boston is minus 4°C
Outdoors	The river path starts at the campus edge. Mountains and coast are a planned weekend trip, not a walk from campus

Malaysian community. The Malaysian Student Association at MIT was founded in 2026 "for students to connect, share, and celebrate Malaysian culture". It has a mailing list, and its committee can be reached at mysa-exec@mit.edu. MIT counted five Malaysian undergraduates and 22 Malaysian students in total in 2025-26, out of 529 international undergraduates.

10. Costs (full)

> All ringgit figures in this report are converted at RM 4.04 per US dollar, the rate on 5 September 2026, and rounded. They will move with the exchange rate.

The sticker price, 2026-27

Line item	USD per year	MYR per year
Tuition	66,720	~RM 269,500
Student life fee	420	~RM 1,700
Housing	14,090	~RM 56,900
Food	8,104	~RM 32,700
Books, course materials, supplies and equipment	930	~RM 3,800
Personal expenses	2,496	~RM 10,100
Published cost of attendance	**92,760**	**~RM 375,000**
MIT student health plan, charged unless you prove comparable cover	5,148	~RM 20,800
Travel home	Estimated by MIT from your home address	Not in the published total
Four years at this year's prices	**371,040**	**~RM 1.50 million**

MIT's course catalogue prints USD 93,730 for the same year without a breakdown. This table uses the itemised figure from Student Financial Services, which is the one aid is calculated against. The published total was USD 89,340 in 2025-26.

What families paid, by income, 2025-26. These are MIT's own estimated medians for students who received an MIT Scholarship. They are not a quote for your family.

Family income	Median MIT Scholarship	Median net price per year	In MYR
USD 0–100,000	USD 85,236	USD 0	RM 0
USD 100,000–200,000	USD 67,848	USD 19,734	~RM 79,700
Over USD 200,000	USD 37,750	USD 49,083	~RM 198,300

MIT says that for families earning under USD 100,000 (~RM 404,000) "parents can expect to pay nothing at all". That line is written around American families "with typical assets", and MIT sets each family's contribution individually from the documents you send.

Your own share. MIT's typical student contribution is USD 5,400 a year (~RM 21,800), meant to come from summer savings and a campus job. Campus jobs pay at least USD 15 an hour. The first USD 5,400 of any outside scholarship can replace it entirely.

Estimating your cost. MIT offers the MyinTuition Quick College Cost Estimator and a Net Price Calculator, and says both "will not be accurate for international students". Your actual figure comes from the CSS Profile, the aid application, after you apply.

One-off costs

Item	USD	MYR
Application fee	75, or a fee waiver	~RM 300
Maker Portfolio	10, waivable	~RM 40
Enrolment deposit	Not found — MIT's catalogue cost page lists the application fee and late-registration fees but no deposit	

11. Scholarships & financial aid

MIT is one of a small group of American universities that is both need-blind and full-need for international students. Need-blind means, in MIT's words, "we don't consider your ability to pay for college in the admissions process". Full-need means it meets "100% of demonstrated financial need". MIT's catalogue adds that this applies to "every undergraduate, regardless of residency or citizenship status" and that aid "never includes loans".

> ⚠️ **MIT gives no merit scholarships, and you only get aid if you file for it.** MIT Scholarships are "awarded based solely on financial need", so A*A*A*A* earns nothing extra. To be considered you must submit the CSS Profile with MIT's code **3514**, and your parents must upload their income documents to IDOC, by **15 February 2027** for Regular Action. File nothing and you are billed the full sticker price.

Scheme	What it pays	Who gets it, and how	Can you apply?
MIT Scholarship	Whatever closes the gap between the cost of attendance and what your family can pay. Median award USD 73,666 in 2025-26	Any admitted undergraduate with demonstrated need. 58% of undergraduates hold one. In 2025-26, 411 international undergraduates received need-based aid averaging USD 81,991 (~RM 331,200). CSS Profile plus IDOC, by the date above. Late filing brings a later answer, not a penalty. You reapply every year	Yes, once admitted

Scheme	What it pays	Who gets it, and how	Can you apply?
MIT First Year Grant	USD 2,000 (~RM 8,100), once	MIT's "highest-need first-year students". Automatic with your aid application	Yes, if MIT places you in that group
MIT Health Insurance Grant	The cost of MIT's student health plan	MIT's "highest-need undergraduates" who lack adequate cover. Automatic with your aid application	Yes, if MIT places you in that group
Merit or athletic awards at MIT	Nothing	They do not exist here	No
Yayasan Khazanah — Khazanah Global Scholarship	Listed as "Full"	Malaysians with 3 As at A-Level (forecast results accepted), no older than 21 at enrolment, with leadership and extracurricular involvement. MIT is on the approved list for Engineering & Technology. Undergraduate applications open "in June, yearly". A conditional offer counts, and you may apply while still waiting for a university decision	Yes, if its other rules fit
MARA	Its domestic loan scheme covers Malaysian institutions only. Its overseas-capable scheme is reserved for top graduates of MARA's own colleges	MARA college graduates	No, MARA college graduates only
JPA	The overseas programme found takes SPM leavers to Japan, Korea, France and Germany. The federal scholarship portal showed no overseas degree scheme for A-Level holders in October 2026	SPM leavers	No, not a US degree route

Scheme	What it pays	Who gets it, and how	Can you apply?
Bank Negara Kijang Undergraduate Scholarship	Overseas study with a two-years-of-service-per-year-of-study bond	Engineering is not among its funded fields	No, engineering is not funded
PTPTN	A loan, for study at Malaysian institutions only	Malaysian institutions	No, not a US degree

What the international paperwork involves. Your parents' tax returns or wage statements "from two years ago", uploaded to IDOC, not sent to MIT. A translation into English is needed if they are in Malay, and MIT says "Professional translation is not required". MIT allows up to two weeks for documents to reach it. For Regular Action the offer arrives by email in mid-March.

How a Malaysian sponsor would interact with MIT's aid. It does not stack. MIT applies the first USD 5,400 of an outside scholarship to your own contribution, then reduces the MIT Scholarship by the rest.

Competitiveness. There is no separate scholarship contest at MIT. Aid follows admission by policy.

12. Outcomes, network & practising in Malaysia

What graduates do

Measure	Figure
Class of 2025 bachelor's graduates going into work	48%
Going to graduate school	42%. Top destinations in 2025 were MIT, Harvard, Stanford and Princeton
Average starting salary for graduates entering industry	USD 145,820 (~RM 589,100), from MIT's most recent graduating survey
Against the national average	MIT's figure across industries is 30–40% above the national average starting salary
Employers hiring from the Class of 2025	Include Apple, Google, Microsoft, Meta, OpenAI, SpaceX, Amazon, Jane Street, McKinsey and Boston Consulting Group
Alumni	148,000 worldwide

Staying to work in the United States. On a student visa you can receive "up to 12 months" of OPT after graduating. Engineering and computing degrees are in fields that qualify for a further "24-month extension", the STEM OPT extension, giving up to three years of US work without entering the H-1B lottery.

Condition	Detail
Employer	Must be enrolled in E-Verify and stay in good standing
Timing	You file for the extension up to 90 days before your first OPT year expires
Later study	A further qualifying degree at a higher level can earn one more 24-month extension

It is permission to work, not a route to stay permanently. After three years you still need an employer to sponsor a work visa.

Practising as an engineer in Malaysia. Recognition is your hard gate.

Gate	Result
Course 2	"Accredited by the Engineering Accreditation Commission of ABET" under the criteria for mechanical engineering
Course 2-A	Also ABET-accredited, under the general engineering criteria
Washington Accord	The United States, through ABET, has been a signatory since 1989 and Malaysia, through BEM, since 2009. Under the accord, "accredited engineering degree programs from one member organisation are mutually recognised by all others"
MQA	Listed. MIT is on MQA's foreign-qualification register (eSISRAF, checked 2026-10-17) under four qualifications: Naval Architecture, Agriculture (BSc), Science (BSc), and Arts and Social Science (BA). MIT awards almost every undergraduate degree, engineering included, as a Bachelor of Science; the register does not name MIT's majors. This register is about recognition for Malaysian government posts; engineer registration is the separate ABET and Washington Accord route above
Course 6 degrees	Their ABET status was not checked for this report

Network. Kendall Square, beside the campus, is a cluster of robotics, software and biotech companies. A 2022 Georgetown University study of 4,500 colleges, cited by MIT, ranked MIT first in the United States for return on investment among bachelor's programmes.

13. Notable facts

- **Hacks.** MIT's word for elaborate, anonymous, harmless engineering pranks. On the last day of classes in May 1994 a campus police car appeared on top of the Great Dome with its lights flashing. It was the outer panels of a Chevrolet Cavalier on a wooden frame, built overnight, with a

dummy officer, a box of donuts, a parking ticket reading "no permit for this location" and the car number pi.

- **Course numbers as identity.** At MIT a major is a number, so Mechanical Engineering is Course 2. Buildings are numbered too, such as W11 and E38.
- **The pirate certificate.** MIT's own fact sheet lists "1 pirate certificate" next to its 56 majors.
- **Robotics pedigree.** iRobot was founded in 1990 by MIT professor Rodney Brooks with two MIT students, Colin Angle and Helen Greiner. Boston Dynamics was founded in 1992 by Marc Raibert as a spin-off from MIT's Leg Laboratory. The 2.007 robot contest inspired FIRST, the school robotics competition, co-founded by Woodie Flowers, the MIT professor who started the contest.
- **A whole month for projects.** January has no regular classes. Past offerings have included a solar-powered sensor build, a stand-up comedy crash course and private pilot ground school.

14. Our assessment (a judgment, not a fact)

Grades vs entry bar: Not published. Our label: your grades compared with the grades this university asks for. Not published means it doesn't set any.

Theme	Our judgment
Fit with what MIT wants	In temperament you sit near the centre of what MIT looks for, closer than at any grades-first system on your list. The gap is documented fit: MIT is being asked to believe in a builder whose building is not yet on paper (§3, §4).
Getting in	MIT cannot be the plan. Your predicted grades clear any bar MIT could set, but at a 2.0% international admit rate grades are a filter you pass, not an argument you win. The Malaysians who get in tend to have one thing at international level. A documented build, with its code and a demo, is the strongest thing you could add (§4).
Scholarship	The strongest answer on your list, and the top of your priorities: need-blind, full-need and no loans. But it depends on being admitted, on the aid forms going in on time, and on MIT reading your family's finances the way its income bands suggest. There is no merit award to fall back on (§10, §11).
Hands-on experience	As good as it gets: research from year one, a robot you build and compete with, and seed funding without having to win a contest. The trade-off is the workload it all sits inside (§6, §7).
Ranking	First in the world overall and in both of your possible fields. Nothing on your list is higher (§2, §5).
Location	Your weakest fit here. Cambridge is nothing like the high-crime areas you ruled out, though it asks for more street sense around Central Square after dark. It is a city with a long winter, and nature is a planned trip. Princeton and Cornell suit that preference better (§9).
Employability	Elite pay and employers, plus up to three years of US work rights, which fits your wish to earn in a stronger currency. It is temporary permission tied to an eligible employer, not a guaranteed route to stay (§12).
Recognition	Clears for Course 2 and Course 2-A through ABET and the Washington Accord, so the degree you declare matters. MIT is on the MQA register, most likely under its Bachelor of Science row (§12).
Choosing your field	Unusually kind to your indecision between mechanical engineering and software. You declare after two terms of real classes and can blend the two in Course 2-A. The cost is a shared science core you do not get to skip, and no certificate that says "Robotics" (§5).

15. Sources

Sources as of the 2026 cycle; Official unless tagged otherwise.

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- MIT Student Financial Services — Making MIT affordable (need blind and full need incl. international, income bands, median net price)
- MIT Student Financial Services — aid application deadlines (30 November / 15 February)
- MIT Student Financial Services — applying for aid as an international student (CSS code 3514, IDOC, translations)
- MIT Student Financial Services — MIT Scholarship (need-based only, median award)
- MIT Student Financial Services — MIT scholarships and grants (First Year Grant, Health Insurance Grant)
- MIT Student Financial Services — outside scholarships and grants (first USD 5,400 replaces student contribution)
- MIT Student Financial Services — estimate your cost (tools not accurate for international students)
- College Board — CSS Profile for international applicants
- MIT Student Financial Services — glossary (student contribution, campus wages, need blind, full need)
- MIT Student Financial Services — return on investment (average starting salary, alumni network)
- MIT Course Catalog — undergraduate costs 2026-27 (tuition per term, fees)
- MIT Course Catalog — undergraduate financial aid (full need regardless of citizenship; never includes loans)
- MIT Student Health Insurance Plan — 2026-27 final premium rates
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- MIT Admissions — admissions statistics, Class of 2029 — as of 2025
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- MIT Admissions — essays, activities and academics
- MIT Admissions — letters of recommendation
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- MIT Admissions — transfer eligibility
- MIT Admissions — majors and minors (apply to the whole university; begin undeclared)

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- MISTI — MIT International Science and Technology Initiatives
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- pset partners — about
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- MIT Campus Dining — meal plans 2026-27
- Malaysian Student Association at MIT
- MIT International Students Office — regional summary 2025-26 — as of 2025
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